

# Submariners' Advocacy Group

## Submariners Helping Submariners

Mission | Vision | Core Values

# Mission

To advocate for the health, recognition, and care of all U.S. Navy Submariners through scientific research, public education, and legislative advocacy.

We are committed to:

- Driving research into submarine-related atmospheric contaminants and other occupational exposures
- Supporting legislation that protects and benefits Submariners
- Educating veterans, families, healthcare providers, and policymakers
- Ensuring every Submariner has access to information, advocacy, and a voice when facing service-connected health challenges.

Home





# Vision

A future where every U.S. Navy Submariner is recognized, supported, and cared for, and where the health consequences of submarine service are fully understood, acknowledged, and never ignored.

We envision a future where:

- Scientific research advances understanding of submarine service-related health conditions.
- Every eligible Submariner receives timely access to earned healthcare, benefits, and compensation.
- Policymakers recognize the unique occupational hazards of submarine service.
- Veterans and their families never face these challenges alone.

Home

# Core Values

Integrity. Professionalism. Courage. Three principles that define who we are and guide everything we do.

- **Integrity**. We lead with honesty, ethics, and accountability. Our advocacy is grounded in facts, transparency, and trust.
- **Professionalism.** We pursue excellence through discipline, credibility, and respect. Every action reflects our commitment to those we serve.
- **Courage**. We challenge injustice, confront difficult truths, and pursue meaningful change for every U.S. Navy Submariner.



Home

# About the Submariners' Advocacy Group

The **Submariners' Advocacy Group (SAG)** is a nonprofit organization founded by U.S. Navy Submariners to serve, support, and advocate for every individual who has earned the right to wear the coveted Submarine Warfare Insignia—better known throughout the Fleet as the Dolphins.

Every member of SAG's leadership has completed the U.S. Navy's demanding submarine qualification process and understands firsthand the unique challenges, sacrifices, and lifelong bonds that define service in the Silent Service. Our shared experiences provide the perspective, credibility, and commitment necessary to advocate effectively on behalf of our submarine community.

Unlike traditional membership organizations, SAG recognizes that earning your Dolphins is membership enough. There are no applications, dues, or eligibility requirements beyond having been qualified in submarines. If you have served as a U.S. Navy Submariner, you are already part of the community we exist to represent.

SAG is dedicated to improving the lives of Submariners through advocacy, education, collaboration, and awareness. We work to ensure that the unique occupational and health concerns associated with submarine service receive the attention they deserve while building partnerships with healthcare professionals, researchers, veterans' organizations, policymakers, and other stakeholders who share our commitment to those who served beneath the sea.

Our mission extends beyond today's veterans. We advocate for active-duty Submariners, retirees, and future generations of undersea warriors by promoting research, supporting informed public policy, and encouraging greater understanding of the extraordinary service performed by the men and women of the United States Submarine Force.

The Silent Service has always been defined by professionalism, sacrifice, and quiet excellence. SAG exists to ensure that same commitment continues long after the watch has ended—serving as a trusted voice for our Brothers and Sisters of the submarine community wherever they may live.

## Our Goals

The Submariners' Advocacy Group is committed to advancing the health, well-being, and recognition of the U.S. Navy submarine community through focused, long-term initiatives that create meaningful and lasting impact.

## Advocate for the Submarine Community

Promote legislation, public policy, and institutional change that improve healthcare, benefits, recognition, and support for U.S. Navy Submariners, their families, and survivors.

## Advance Research

Support the development of a nationwide Submariner registry, encourage scientific and medical research, and collaborate with leading academic and research institutions to better understand the long-term effects of submarine service.

## Educate and Inform

Develop educational resources for Veteran Service Officers, healthcare professionals, policymakers, and the public to increase understanding of submarine operations, occupational exposures, and the unique challenges faced by those who served beneath the sea.

## Build Strategic Partnerships

Establish collaborative relationships with veterans organizations, military commands, healthcare providers, universities, researchers, and government agencies to strengthen advocacy efforts and expand available resources.

## Support Submariners and Their Families

Provide trusted information, guidance, and advocacy for Submariners, their families, and surviving family members while fostering a lifelong community built on shared service and mutual support.

Board of Directors

Regional Representatives

# Board of Directors



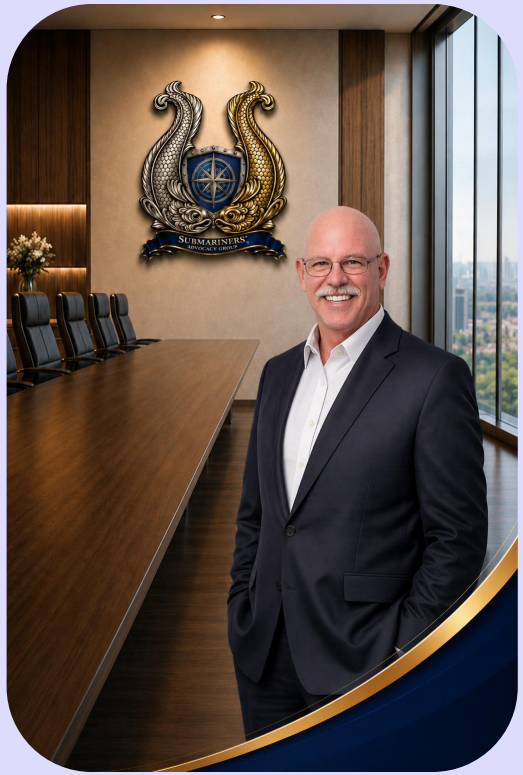
Chairman of the Board
Stanley Martinez



President / Executive Director
David Bozarth

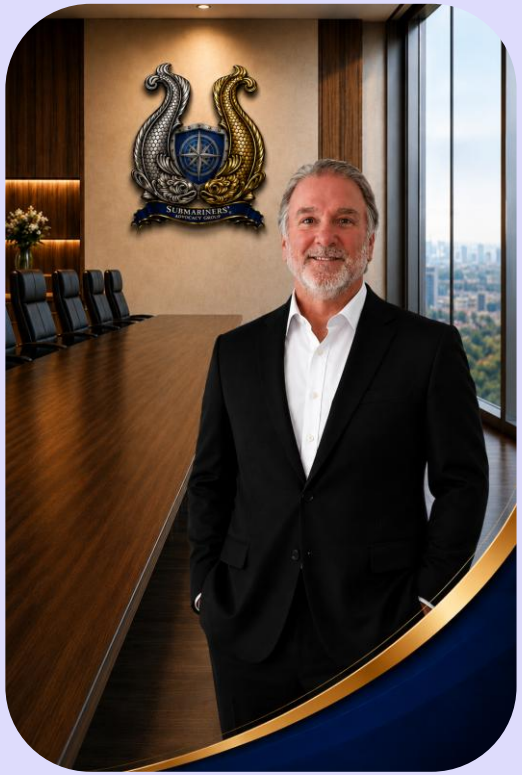


Director of Governance
Board Secretary
Scott Muranko

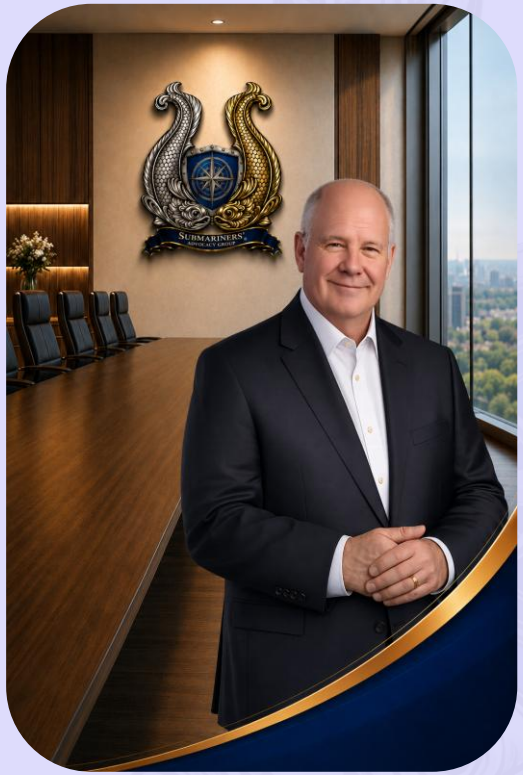


Vice Chairman
Chuck Sanders

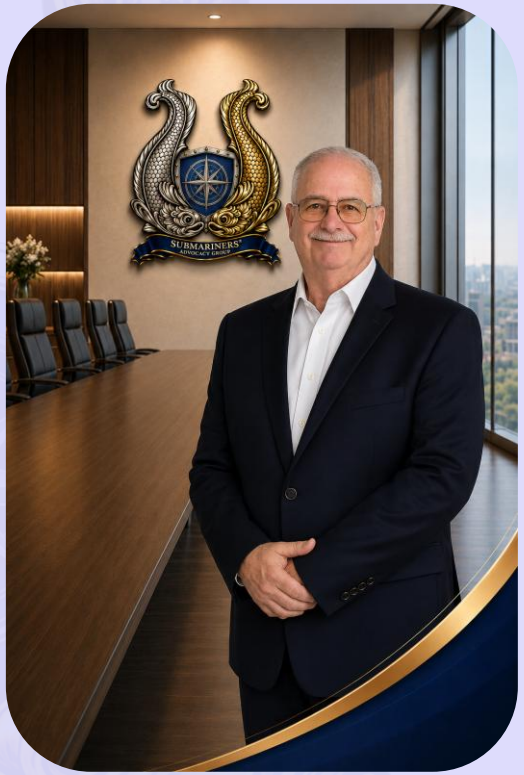
# Board of Directors



Chief Financial Officer
Treasurer
Dana Widmayer



Board Member
Jerry Lainhart



Board Member
Patrick Ivory



Board Member
Randy Engness

# Board of Directors



RODNEY BOUCHER

Board Member
Bruce Tarleton

Board Member
Rodney Boucher




# Chairman of the Board
# Stanley Martinez

Stanley Martinez is a founding member and currently serves as Chairman of the Board for the Submariners' Advocacy Group (SAG), helping lead the organization's mission to advocate for U.S. Navy Submariners, veterans, and their families. As one of SAG's founding leaders, Stanley has played a central role in helping shape the organization's strategic direction, outreach efforts, and growing national advocacy presence within the veteran and submarine communities.

A proud supporter of the Silent Service community, Stanley has dedicated himself to increasing awareness surrounding the unique operational demands and long-term health concerns associated with submarine duty. He remains deeply committed to educating current and former Submariners about the potential impacts of toxic exposures, radiation, and other unseen hazards associated with service beneath the sea, while advocating for improved awareness, recognition, and support for affected veterans.

In addition to his leadership role within SAG, Stanley has maintained a long and distinguished record of service and advocacy within the Veterans of Foreign Wars (VFW). In the state of Utah, he served as State Commander from 2017 to 2018 and later served on the VFW National Legislative Committee from 2020 through 2024. His leadership within the veteran community reflects a continued commitment to supporting veterans at both the state and national levels.

Stanley is a Gold Legacy Life Member of the Veterans of Foreign Wars and the VFW National Home. He is also a Life Member of the Disabled American Veterans (DAV), Fleet Reserve Association (FRA), and the American Legion.

Further reflecting his commitment to national service, Stanley currently serves as a Presidential Appointee and lifetime board member for the United States Selective Service System.

Stanley holds a bachelor's degree in Medical Management and continues to dedicate his time and leadership toward advancing veteran advocacy, organizational growth, and support for the Submarine Force community.

Board of Directors Home




# President / Executive Director
# David Bozarth

David Bozarth is a founding member and currently serves as President and Executive Director of the Submariners' Advocacy Group (SAG), where he leads the organization's national advocacy efforts on behalf of U.S. Navy Submariners, veterans, and their families. As one of SAG's principal founders, David has played a central role in shaping the organization's mission, strategic direction, and growing national presence within the veteran advocacy community.

Raised in a small rural town in Missouri, David developed a strong sense of patriotism, service, and duty from an early age. He enlisted in the United States Navy in 1978 and soon volunteered for submarine duty, beginning his journey into the Silent Service. After graduating at the top of his class from Basic Enlisted Submarine School in Groton, Connecticut, he completed follow-on technical training through Polaris Electronics "A" School and advanced Fire Control Technician "C" School training for the Poseidon Weapons System.

David subsequently reported aboard USS LEWIS AND CLARK (SSBN 644) (GOLD Crew), where he earned his Qualified in Submarines designation in February 1981. During his assignment aboard LEWIS AND CLARK, he qualified as a Missile Control Center Technician, Nuclear Weapons Security Guard, and Missile Control Center Supervisor. His operational experience included multiple strategic deterrent patrols, operational testing of the Poseidon Missile System, and participation in an extended refueling overhaul and post-shipyard recertification process supporting the nation's strategic nuclear deterrence mission.

Following his honorable discharge from the United States Navy in 1984, David transitioned into the civilian sector, applying the technical expertise and operational discipline developed during his submarine service to careers supporting Department of the Navy and United States Marine Corps electronic security systems, information technology, information security, and project management initiatives. Throughout his civilian career, he has supported complex global information systems while continuing to dedicate time and expertise to nonprofit and veteran-service organizations.

David is also a Life Member of the Veterans of Foreign Wars (VFW), where he has served in multiple leadership positions, including District Commander. Under his leadership, Missouri VFW District 7 achieved All-American status in 2022, 2023, and 2025. He has consistently utilized his leadership platform to advocate for greater awareness, visibility, and recognition of the service and sacrifices of Submariners and veterans of the Silent Service.

In March 2024, David recognized the growing need to advocate for Submariners affected by long-term toxic exposure concerns associated with the closed-loop atmosphere aboard U.S. Navy submarines. Following extensive research and collaboration with fellow Submarine veterans, he spearheaded the formation of the Submariners' Advocacy Group in April 2024 alongside a team of fellow Submariners committed to advancing awareness and advocacy for the undersea warfare community.

Under David's leadership as Executive Director, SAG has experienced rapid organizational growth and has become an increasingly recognized voice advocating for Submariners nationwide. His leadership, passion, and unwavering commitment to the Silent Service continue to drive SAG's mission to support, educate, and advocate for those who have served beneath the sea.

Board of Directors Home




# Director of Governance / Board Secretary
# Scott Muranko

Scott Muranko serves on the Board of Directors for the Submariners' Advocacy Group (SAG) as Secretary of the Board and Director of Governance. A retired U.S. Navy Senior Chief Yeoman (Submarines), Scott brings more than two decades of submarine service and over twenty years of leadership experience in manufacturing operations, workforce development, and technical training to the organization's mission of advocating for U.S. Navy Submariners and their families.

Born and raised in Sterling, Virginia, Scott entered the United States Navy shortly after graduating high school with the intention of becoming a nuclear power operator. When a diagnosis of color blindness redirected his career path, he adapted without hesitation—transitioning into the Yeoman rating before volunteering for submarine duty and beginning what would become a distinguished twenty-year career in the Silent Service.

After completing Basic Enlisted Submarine School in January 1986, Scott reported aboard USS LEWIS AND CLARK (SSBN 644) (BLUE Crew) in Charleston, South Carolina. He earned his Qualified in Submarines designation during his second deterrent patrol and completed eight strategic deterrent patrols before transferring ashore as a Yeoman Second Class (Submarines).

Scott's first shore assignment was with Navy Nuclear Field "A" School in Orlando, Florida, where he advanced to Yeoman First Class (Submarines). Eager to return to sea duty, he volunteered for assignment aboard USS WEST VIRGINIA (SSBN 736) (GOLD Crew) in Kings Bay, Georgia, serving as Leading Yeoman and earning selection to Chief Petty Officer following his fifth patrol with the crew.

He later served on the staff of Commander, Submarine Group Ten in Kings Bay, Georgia, where he helped oversee administrative and personnel support operations for multiple submarine crews and shore commands. Scott subsequently returned to sea aboard USS LOUISIANA (SSBN 743) (BLUE Crew), participating in the crew's first five strategic deterrent patrols and advancing to Senior Chief Petty Officer.

Scott concluded his Navy career with Navy Recruiting District Denver, where his leadership contributed to the command being recognized as the top recruiting district in the nation for three consecutive years. Following twenty years of honorable and distinguished naval service, he retired from active duty and transferred to the Fleet Reserve.

Following his military retirement, Scott transitioned into the manufacturing and automotive sectors, building a second career focused on operational excellence, technical workforce development, and organizational training leadership. His civilian leadership experience includes positions with Coors, Lucid Motors, Carvana, and Ball Corporation. Throughout his post-Navy career, he has led large-scale technical training initiatives, building workforce development programs, and supported global manufacturing operations across multiple industries.

Since joining the SAG Board of Directors in 2025, Scott has played a central role in organizational governance modernization, board development, strategic communications, and advocacy initiatives focused on the long-term health impacts associated with submarine service. He also contributed to the development of The Unseen Burden: Toxic Exposures and Health Impacts on U.S. Navy Submariners, a landmark report examining the hidden health consequences associated with prolonged exposure to the closed-loop atmosphere aboard U.S. Navy submarines.

Scott currently resides in Phoenix, Arizona, with his wife, Melissa.

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# Vice Chairman
# Charles “Chuck” Sanders

Charles “Chuck” Sanders serves in a leadership role within the Submariners’ Advocacy Group (SAG), supporting the organization’s mission to advocate for U.S. Navy Submariners, veterans, and their families. A proud member of the Silent Service community, Chuck brings decades of technical expertise, operational experience, and continued dedication to supporting fellow veterans and Submariners.

During his naval career, Chuck served in the United States Navy Submarine Force, where he developed the technical discipline, operational focus, and mission-oriented mindset that would continue to define both his military and civilian careers. His time within the Silent Service reinforced the values of professionalism, accountability, teamwork, and service that remain central to his work today.

Following his military service, Chuck built an extensive civilian career centered on advanced electronics, telecommunications, and network infrastructure systems. From 1991 through 2001, he served as a Senior Electronic Engineering Technician with the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) in the Alaska Region, supporting critical technical and communications infrastructure in one of the nation’s most demanding operational environments.

Chuck later continued his technical and public service career with the State of Missouri Department of Higher Education and Workforce Development, where he served from 2002 through 2024 as both a Senior Telecommunications Technician and Senior Network Infrastructure Technician. Throughout this career, he supported complex communications and network systems while contributing to the operational reliability and technological infrastructure supporting higher education and workforce development initiatives across the state.

Chuck’s combined background in submarine operations, advanced technical systems, telecommunications, and public-sector infrastructure support provides valuable perspective within SAG’s leadership team. His experience reflects a lifelong commitment to disciplined service, technical excellence, and supporting both the veteran and Submarine communities.

Within SAG, Chuck supports initiatives focused on advocacy, organizational growth, awareness, and strengthening support networks for current and former Submariners. His dedication reflects SAG’s core values of integrity, professionalism, and service to the Silent Service community.

Chuck remains committed to supporting fellow Submariners and helping ensure their service, sacrifices, and long-term health concerns continue to receive meaningful advocacy and recognition.

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# Chief Financial Officer / Treasurer
# Dana Widmayer

Dana Widmayer serves as the Chief Financial Officer (CFO) for the Submariners' Advocacy Group (SAG), where he supports the organization's financial stewardship, operational accountability, and long-term sustainability initiatives. In this role, he helps oversee financial planning, fiscal compliance, and organizational resource management in support of SAG's mission to advocate for U.S. Navy Submariners, veterans, and their families.

A proud member of the Silent Service community, Dana previously served aboard USS LEWIS AND CLARK (SSBN 644), where he gained firsthand experience in the operational demands, discipline, and unique culture of submarine service. His connection to the Submarine Force continues to shape his commitment to supporting fellow Submariners and advocating for the long-term well-being of the undersea warfare community.

Throughout his professional career, Dana has built extensive experience in financial management, administrative operations, and organizational support. His background includes leadership in budgeting, financial oversight, reporting, and business operations, bringing both precision and professionalism to the nonprofit sector.

As part of SAG's executive leadership team, Dana plays an important role in supporting the organization's continued growth and development as it expands its advocacy efforts, member services, outreach initiatives, and national visibility. His commitment to accountability, professionalism, and mission-focused service helps strengthen SAG's ability to support the Submarine community and advocate for issues affecting current and former Submariners.

Dana's dedication to supporting the Submarine Force community reflects SAG's core values of integrity, professionalism, and service. Through his work behind the scenes, he contributes to the organizational foundation necessary to sustain effective advocacy and long-term impact for the Silent Service community.

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# Board of Directors
# Jerry Lainhart

Jerry D. Lainhart serves on the Board of Directors for the Submariners' Advocacy Group (SAG), supporting the organization's mission to advocate for U.S. Navy Submariners, veterans, and their families. A qualified Submariner and proud member of the Silent Service community, Jerry brings operational submarine experience, professional leadership, and a lifelong commitment to service to SAG's growing national advocacy efforts.

Jerry qualified in submarines aboard USS CAVALLA (SSN 684) in March 1990 while serving as an Electronics Technician. During his assignment aboard CAVALLA from 1989 through 1993, he supported the demanding operational mission requirements associated with fast-attack submarine operations during a critical period in modern naval history. His time in the Submarine Force instilled the values of professionalism, accountability, teamwork, and mission-focused service that continue to guide him today.

Following his naval service, Jerry pursued higher education and professional development, earning a Bachelor of Science degree from Brigham Young University in 1999 and a Master of Science degree from the University of Wisconsin–Platteville in 2005. He later achieved certification as a Project Management Professional (PMP), further strengthening his leadership and organizational management expertise.

Jerry's combined background in submarine operations, technical systems, higher education, and project management provides valuable perspective in support of SAG's mission and organizational growth. His experience reflects a continued commitment to professional excellence, disciplined leadership, and supporting fellow members of the Submarine community.

As part of SAG's leadership team, Jerry supports initiatives focused on advocacy, awareness, and strengthening support networks for current and former Submariners. His dedication reflects SAG's core values of integrity, professionalism, and service to the Silent Service community.

Jerry currently resides in Thayne, Wyoming, with his wife, LaDawna.

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# Board of Directors
# Patrick Ivory

Patrick Ivory serves in a leadership role within the Submariners' Advocacy Group (SAG), supporting the organization's mission to advocate for U.S. Navy Submariners, veterans, and their families. A proud member of the Silent Service community, Patrick brings decades of submarine experience, operational leadership, and continued dedication to supporting those who have served beneath the sea.

Throughout his naval career, Patrick served aboard multiple U.S. Navy submarines, gaining firsthand experience in the demanding operational environment, discipline, and unique brotherhood associated with undersea warfare. His service within the Submarine Force provided extensive leadership experience while reinforcing the values of accountability, professionalism, teamwork, and mission accomplishment that continue to guide his work today.

Over the course of his distinguished submarine career, Patrick supported critical operational missions and contributed to the readiness and effectiveness of the crews and commands with which he served. His experiences in the Silent Service established a lifelong commitment to supporting fellow Submariners and advocating for the recognition and support they deserve long after their military service concludes.

Following his military career, Patrick continued to build upon his leadership and professional experience through work focused on operational support, organizational collaboration, and community engagement. His ability to connect with others, remain mission-focused, and support organizational growth has made him a valued contributor within both professional and veteran-service environments.

Within SAG, Patrick supports initiatives designed to strengthen advocacy efforts, expand organizational outreach, and increase awareness surrounding the long-term impacts associated with submarine service. His commitment to service reflects SAG's core values of integrity, professionalism, and dedication to the Silent Service community.

Patrick remains committed to ensuring that current and former Submariners, as well as their families, continue to receive meaningful advocacy, support, and recognition for their sacrifices and contributions to national defense.

Board of Directors Home




# Board of Directors
# Randy Engness

Randy Engness serves in a leadership role within the Submariners' Advocacy Group (SAG), supporting the organization's mission to advocate for U.S. Navy Submariners, veterans, and their families. As a member of the Silent Service community, Randy brings operational submarine experience, professional leadership, and a continued commitment to supporting fellow Submariners and the broader veteran community.

Throughout his naval career, Randy served in the United States Navy Submarine Force, where he gained firsthand experience operating within the demanding and highly disciplined environment unique to undersea warfare. His service in the Silent Service reinforced the values of accountability, teamwork, professionalism, and mission-focused leadership that continue to guide both his professional and advocacy efforts today.

Following his military service, Randy continued building upon the technical and leadership foundation established during his submarine career through continued professional development and organizational support roles. His experience reflects a strong commitment to disciplined service, operational excellence, and supporting mission-driven organizations.

Within SAG, Randy supports initiatives focused on advocacy, awareness, organizational development, and strengthening support networks for current and former Submariners. He remains dedicated to increasing awareness surrounding the long-term impacts associated with submarine service while supporting efforts to ensure Submariners receive the recognition, advocacy, and support they deserve.

Randy's continued dedication to the Silent Service community reflects SAG's core values of integrity, professionalism, and service. Through his work with SAG, he remains committed to supporting those who have served beneath the sea and advocating for the long-term well-being of Submariners and their families.

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# Board of Directors
# Bruce Tarleton

Bruce Tarleton is a founding member of the Submariners' Advocacy Group (SAG) and serves as a leading voice in the organization's mission to advocate for U.S. Navy Submariners, veterans, and their families. A proud member of the Silent Service community, Bruce has dedicated himself to increasing awareness surrounding the long-term health impacts and unseen hazards associated with submarine service.

Throughout his naval career, Bruce served in the United States Navy Submarine Force, where he gained firsthand experience operating within the demanding and highly disciplined environment unique to undersea warfare. His service in the Silent Service instilled the values of professionalism, accountability, resilience, and mission-focused teamwork that continue to guide his advocacy efforts today.

Bruce's personal experiences following his submarine service became a driving force behind his commitment to supporting fellow Submariners and raising awareness surrounding the long-term health concerns affecting the undersea warfare community. Recognizing the need for stronger advocacy, improved awareness, and increased support for those exposed to the unique environmental conditions associated with submarine operations, he became one of the driving forces behind the formation and growth of SAG.

As a founding member of SAG, Bruce has helped support organizational outreach, veteran engagement, awareness initiatives, and advocacy efforts focused on ensuring the experiences and sacrifices of Submariners receive the attention and recognition they deserve. His continued dedication reflects SAG's core values of integrity, professionalism, and service to the Silent Service community.

Bruce remains committed to supporting current and former Submariners while helping advance national awareness regarding the long-term health and exposure concerns associated with life beneath the sea.

Board of Directors Home

RODNEY BOUCHER

## Board of Directors
## Rodney Boucher

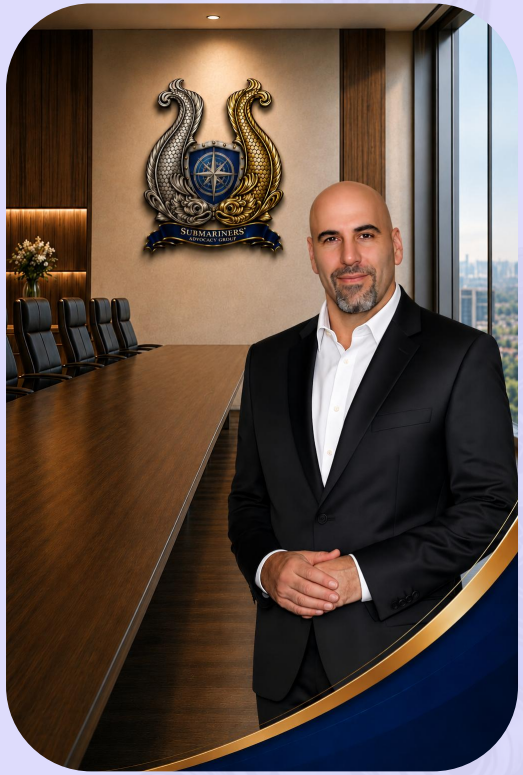
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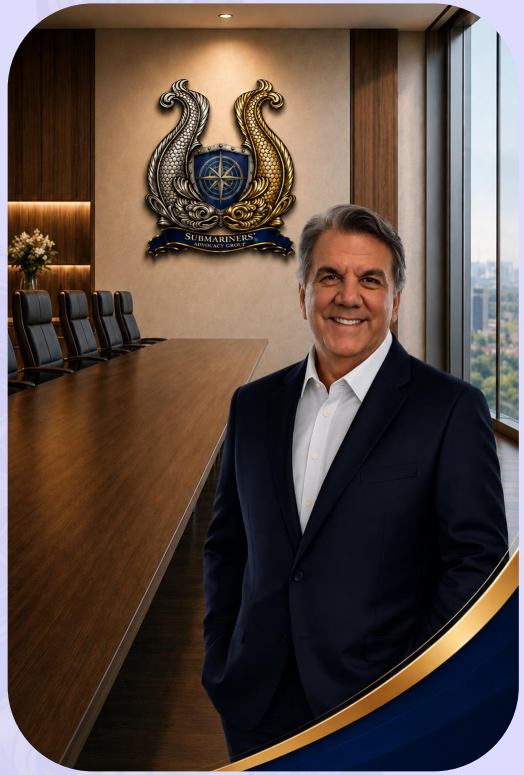
Board of Directors Home

# Regional Representatives

NEW ENGLAND

EDWARD PERRY







New England
Ed Perry

Mid-Atlantic / Capital
John Lofstock

Southeast Atlantic 1
Robert Mayfield

Southeast Atlantic 2
Scott Brown

# Regional Representatives



Gulf Coast
Leland Marcus



Central Plains
Kevin Kettner



Mountain / Inland West
Monte Bush

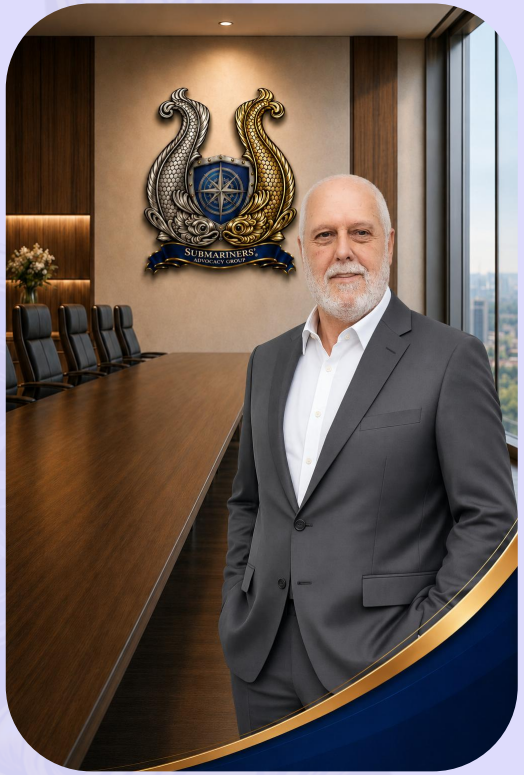


California / Pacific
Oscar Sanchez-Huerta

# Regional Representatives



Pacific Northwest 1
Bill Longworth



Pacific Northwest 2
Doug Hase

EDWARD PERRY

## Regional Representative – New England
## Edward Perry

# PLACEHOLDER

Regional Representatives Home




## Regional Representative – Mid-Atlantic / Capital
## John Lofstock

# PLACEHOLDER

Regional Representatives Home




## Regional Representative – Southeast Atlantic 1
## Robert Mayfield

# PLACEHOLDER

Regional Representatives Home




## Regional Representative – Southeast Atlantic 2
## Scott Brown

# PLACEHOLDER

Regional Representatives Home




## Regional Representative – Gulf Coast
## Leland Marcus

# PLACEHOLDER

Regional Representatives Home




## Regional Representative – Central Plains
## Kevin Kettner

# PLACEHOLDER

Regional Representatives Home




## Regional Representative – Mountain / Inland West
## Monte Bush

# PLACEHOLDER

Regional Representatives Home




## Regional Representative – California / Pacific
## Oscar Sanchez-Huerta

# PLACEHOLDER

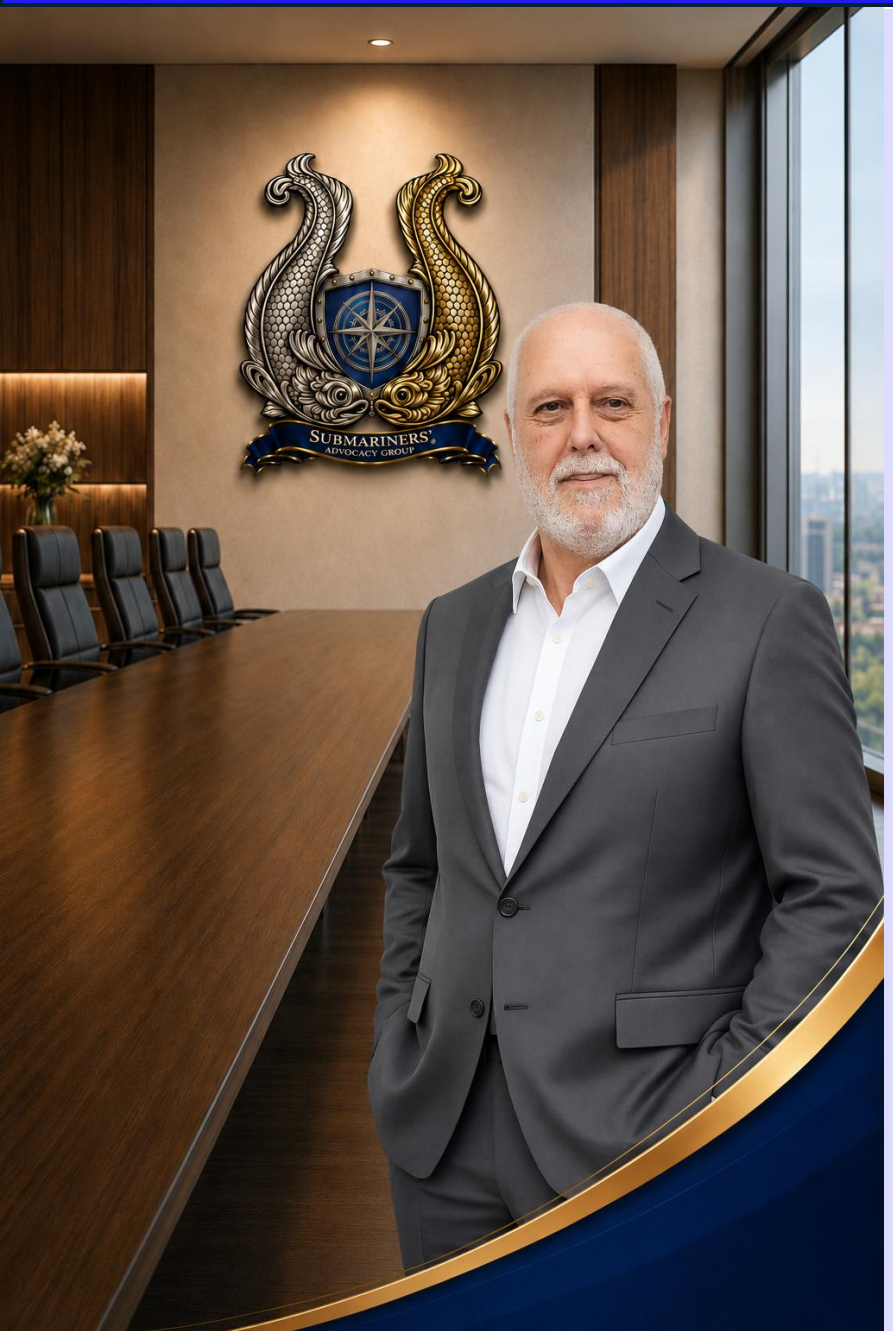
Regional Representatives Home




## Regional Representative –Pacific Northwest 1
## Bill Longworth

# PLACEHOLDER

Regional Representatives Home




## Regional Representative –Pacific Northwest 2
## Doug Hase

# PLACEHOLDER

Regional Representatives Home